In 1982, the UK government established a committee headed by the moral philosopher Mary Warnock, to think about the associated public policy problems. The Warnock report was delivered in 1984 and led up to the ‘Human Fertilization and Embryology Act’ of 1990. This Act created the ‘Human Fertilization and Embryology Authority’ (HFEA) to adjudicate and license all work on human embryos, whether for IVF or for scientific study. [1]

How might things have worked out in the Indian policy process? We can see a few potential pitfalls:

- Right in 1978, when there was public criticism, there is a likelihood of a simple ban coming about. There is a bias, in India, for muscular responses to current newspaper stories. Letting the field unfold under laissez faire for four years is an unlikely event in the Indian policy process. As the securities expert Ashish Chauhan pleads, ‘First you have to have a market, and only then you can regulate it.’
- If a committee had to be created, it would have been hard to find a moral philosopher to head it, as the humanities have atrophied in Indian universities.
- The translation of the report into the Act would have been done badly.
- The translation of the law into state capacity at HFEA would have been done badly.

This example encourages us to see the full pipeline of the policy process, and work on strengthening all elements of it.

The policy pipeline

Stage 1 of the policy pipeline is the establishment of the statistical system. Facts need to be systematically captured. Without facts, the entire